

Audit Trail — User Guide

Audit Trail records **who did what, to which watched record, when**, with the field values before and after the change. You choose which kinds of records to watch, per company, and switch watching on deliberately. A scheduled clean-up can remove old history once you enable it.

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1. Overview

Screen	Menu	Purpose
Watch Rules (<code>audit.rule</code>)	Audit → Configuration → Rules	Which kind of record is watched, in which company, which actions and how much detail
Recorded Events (<code>audit.log</code>)	Audit → Logs	One row per create / change / delete / export / list open
Field Changes (<code>audit.log.line</code>)	Audit → Log Lines	One row per changed field, searchable across every watched kind of record
Working Sessions (<code>audit.session</code>)	Audit → Sessions	Sign-in time, browser and network address of the visit that produced events

2. Installation

1. Open **Apps**, search for **Audit Trail**, click **Activate**.
2. The module depends on `base`, `web`, `base_setup` and `product` (Price Lists). No other app is installed.
3. After installation the **Audit** menu appears for the administrator. System administrators

automatically receive the **Audit Administrator** role.

3. Roles and Access

Role	Watch Rules	Recorded Events / Field Changes / Sessions
Auditor (<code>audit_trail.group_audit_user</code>)	Read	Read
Audit Administrator (<code>audit_trail.group_audit_manager</code> , includes Auditor)	Read, create, edit, delete	Read and delete (never edit)

- Every record is limited to the companies the user is allowed to work in.
- The **View Logs** button on Contacts, Bank Accounts and Price Lists is visible only to Auditors and Audit Administrators.
- The **Rules** menu requires Audit Administrator; the **Settings** menu requires the Odoo system administrator role.

4. Configuration

4.1 Create a watch rule

1. Go to **Audit → Configuration → Rules** and click **New**.
2. Fill **Name** (e.g. "Contacts") and **Kind of Record** (e.g. Contact). **Company** defaults to your current company.
3. Choose the **Detail Level**:
 - **Full** — keeps old and new values. Slower: the whole record is re-read before and after every change.
 - **Light** — keeps only the new value of each changed field. Faster, but you lose the old value.
4. On the **Actions to Record** tab, tick what to record: **Record Creation**, **Record Changes**, **Record Deletion**, **Record Exports**, **Record List Opens**.
 - **Record List Opens** is off by default. Every list showing more than one watched record creates an event, which can mean thousands of rows a day. A single record opened on its own is never recorded.
5. **Keep a Copy on Deletion** stores the full contents of each deleted record (extra database space).
6. On the **Exclusions** tab, list **People to Exclude** and **Fields to Exclude**.
7. Click **Confirm**. The rule becomes **Active** and recording starts.

Only one rule per kind of record and company is allowed. A second one is refused with a message naming the existing rule.

4.2 Change a rule

While a rule is **Active**, its watch settings are locked (a blue banner says so). Click **Set to Draft**, change the settings, then **Confirm** again. Nothing is recorded while the rule is in Draft. An active rule cannot be deleted; set it to Draft first.

5. Daily Use

5.1 Recorded Events

Audit → Logs lists events with date, record, kind of record, action and user. Use **Group By → User / Kind of Record / Action / Date / Working Session**, or the filters **Creations, Changes, Deletions, Exports, List Opens**.

The event form shows who / when / which record / which action / detail level, and the **Field Changes** table (field, old value, new value). Buttons:

- **Open Record** — opens the watched record (hidden for deletions, exports and list opens). If the record has since been deleted, a warning notification says so instead.
- **View Exported Records** — shown only on export events; opens exactly the records that were exported.
- A **Deleted Record Contents** tab appears on deletion events when a copy was kept.

5.2 Worked example

Rule "Contacts", Full detail, active. A user changes the phone of Deco Addict from (603)–996–3829 to (603)–996–4100:

Field	Old Value	New Value
Phone	(603)-996-3829	(603)-996-4100

With **Light** detail the same change stores **Old Value** empty and **New Value** (603)–996–4100. If the user saves without changing anything, no event is written.

5.3 Field Changes

Audit → Log Lines is a flat list of every changed field across all watched kinds of records. Search by record, field label, old or new value, kind of record or user.

5.4 From a watched record

On a Contact, Bank Account or Price List form, click **View Logs** to see that record's history only.

5.5 Working Sessions

Audit → Sessions shows the user, sign-in time, last activity, browser and network address, and the

number of recorded events. Open a session to see its events. A session is created the first time a signed-in person triggers a recorded event, so **Sign-in Time** is the time of that first event, not of the actual login.

6. Field Reference

Watch Rule (`audit.rule`)

Field	Meaning
<code>name</code>	Rule name
<code>model_id</code>	Kind of record watched
<code>company_id</code>	Company whose users' changes are recorded
<code>state</code>	Draft / Active
<code>detail_level</code>	Full / Light
<code>track_create</code> , <code>track_write</code> , <code>track_unlink</code> , <code>track_export</code> , <code>track_read</code>	Actions recorded
<code>keep_deleted_copy</code>	Store deleted record contents
<code>excluded_user_ids</code> , <code>excluded_field_ids</code>	Never-recorded people and fields

Recorded Event (`audit.log`)

`rule_id`, `res_model`, `res_id`, `record_name`, `action`, `user_id`, `date`, `detail_level`, `company_id`, `deleted_data`, `exported_res_ids`, `session_id`, `source_action`, `line_ids`.

Field Change (`audit.log.line`)

`log_id`, `field_id`, `field_description`, `old_value`, `new_value`, plus read-only copies of `date`, `user_id`, `record_name`, `res_model`, `res_id`, `action`, `company_id`, `session_id` for searching.

7. Scheduled Clean-up

1. Go to **Audit → Configuration → Settings** (or **Settings → Audit Trail**).
2. Tick **Remove Old History** and set **Keep history for ... months** (default 6).
3. The daily job **Audit Trail: Remove Expired History** deletes up to 1,000 events per run for companies that switched it on, oldest first, and asks the scheduler to run again until it has caught up.

Example: clean-up enabled with 6 months on 26 September 2026 → events dated before 26 March 2026 are removed for that company only. Other companies keep everything.

Audit Administrators can also delete events by hand from **Audit → Logs** (select → Actions → Delete).



8. Demo Data

Demo databases contain three **Draft** rules (Contacts, Bank Accounts, Price Lists), three working sessions and ten illustrative events (phone and e-mail changes on contacts, a bank account number change and deletion, price list changes, exports). Nothing is recorded until you confirm a rule.

9. Limitations

- Recording applies to changes made through Odoo's ORM (screens, imports, API). Direct SQL changes are not seen.
- The company of an event is the user's **current company** at the time of the change, not the record's own company.
- Only stored fields are compared; binary/image and one-to-many fields are not recorded (their child records can be watched with their own rule).
- **Source Screen** is best-effort, read from the browser address; it may be empty for API calls.
- There is no approval, blocking, alerting or tamper-proof sealing: Audit Administrators can delete history.
- If recording fails for any reason, the user's action still succeeds and the failure is written to the server log.

